

green oven mitt (or red or other suitably festive color) can be paired with red and green Hershey's Kisses for a holiday-ready and most useful gift.

## 6. Kitchen towels

If you like the kitchen linen idea but want something more elegant, consider buying a set of kitchen towels (or cloth napkins); tie with a nice ribbon.

## 7. Bowls

You can also buy a set of bowls and give them individually; add a decorative touch of ribbon or home-cooked treat.

## 8. Measuring cup

For a super-practical and nearly everlasting gift (perhaps for newlyweds who forgot to put a measuring cup on their registry), get a Pyrex glass measuring cup. I use mine for measuring *and* boiling water in the microwave.

## 9. Coffee mug

Someone starting out is most likely to enjoy a sturdy coffee mug. Most clearance shelves will have a variety of fun and quirky cups. Classic white goes

with nearly any china pattern so even more established recipients can use it.

## 10. Handmade recycled drinking glass

Jahanara Cottage Industries is an artisan group in rural Bangladesh supplied through Ten Thousand Villages ([TenThousandVillages.ca](http://TenThousandVillages.ca)). Ten Thousand Villages works with artisans in developing countries and impoverished areas worldwide. Artisans are paid a fair wage (that is enough to support their families and educate their children; hence, the term "fair trade") in an arrangement that gives artisans merchandising direction, provides payment advances, and guarantees payment of completed work. There are shops throughout the United States and Canada, an online store, and partner stores (where some, but not all, merchandise is supplied by Ten Thousand Villages). You can find a variety of beautiful pieces.

## 11. Conversation pieces

While you're visiting Ten Thousand Villages, you can check out their clearance section to find handcrafted bargains.